

ENG 101
Lesson -28

Practice 1.

Rewrite the following sentences changing the expressions of slang by using more effective language.

1. All the viewers trashed the new Tom Cruise film.
2. I was really cheesed off when Rizwan called me a lair.
3. Working in the library has been a real drag.

CLICHES

After all is said and done	clear as crystal
a long felt want	cool as a cucumber
avoid like the plague	light as a feather
bored to tears	make ends meet
better half	pretty as a picture
bolt from the blue	red as a rose
busy as a bee	sick and tired
cold as ice	tried and true
in this day and age	time and again

Cliches e.g.

- i. The boys in my class were down in the dumps because they were fighting a losing battle with their discrete maths course.
- ii. She speaks loud enough to wake the dead.
- iii. The children in the nursery class have been busy as bees all day, but they still seem fresh as daisies.

Wordy Expression

Single Word

a large number of	many
at an earlier point in time	before
at this point in time	now
due to the fact that	because
during the time that	while
each and every day	daily
few in number	few
green in color	green
in order to	to

in my own opinion	I think
in the event that	if
in the near future	soon
made the decision to	decided
on account of	because
postponed until later	postponed
small in size	small

Look at the following sentences and see which ones communicate well.

1. Due to the fact that the printer ran out of the toner, they went to the local store for the purpose of buying some.
- Because the printer ran out of the toner, they went to a local store to buy some.
2. At this point in time we have not yet scheduled the date of the next meeting.
-We have not yet scheduled the next meeting.
3. In my opinion, I think the quota system in jobs is totally unfair and uncalled for.
- I think that job quotas are unfair.
1. My neighbor's conversation is too gross for me.
2. The audience was bored to tears by the lecture on Iqbal.
3. Owing to the fact that the buses are on strike, no one arrived on time.
4. The boys are pulling your leg when they say they can't be at your party. Don't listen to their teasing - they wouldn't miss your party for the world.
5. You can't believe what my neighbor says. He's a gas bag. During the time I've known him I've heard him tell many lies.
6. She was as happy as a lark when she learned that she had got an A on her term paper. But her happiness didn't last long due to the fact that there had been a complete mistake in the compiling of result.

- (i) its: This is the possessive of it.
It's: a contraction of it is.

-When she saw my dress, she said "It's" an unusual one, but I like its colour.

(ii) There: (a) in that place (b) used with **is, are, was, were** and other forms of the verb **to be**. Their: belonging to them.

They're: contraction of they are.

-The teacher told the students that there was no excuse for their failing in the test; they're going to sit for another test.

-Their belongings were scattered over there on the hill side. Tomorrow there will be an inquiry in the incident.

(iii) your: belonging to you

you're: contraction of you are

-If you're going out in this heat, take your umbrella (belonging to you) for protection.

-Do you think your family will be upset when they learn you're migrating to Canada? (the family belonging to you).

-(iv) passed: The past tense of pass

(a) handed to

(b) went by

(c) completed successfully.

past: (a) time before the present

-As Sajjad Ali walked past the fire, he passed his hands over it(v) Whose: belonging to whom

Who's: contraction of who is or who has

- The headmaster yelled, "Who's responsible for the destruction of the painting? Whose fault is it?"

(vi) Weather: Outside conditions (rain, wind, temperature,...)

Whether: if

-The weather won't spoil our holidays; whether it rains or not, our days will be spent fishing and boating.

(vii) All ready: (two words) completely prepared.

Already: (adverb) previously or before; prior to some specified time.

- They were all ready for the work to begin.

- *We were surprised to find the woman already there when we arrived.*

(viii) Altogether: (adverb) meaning wholly or thoroughly.

All together: (two words) meaning simultaneously or “all at once”.

- *The customers were altogether satisfied. (thoroughly).*

- *They were all together in the waiting room by eight o’ clock.*

(ix) Angry *about*: We are angry *about* occasions or situations.

Angry *with*: We are angry *with* people

Angry *at*: We are angry *at* things /animals

- *We were all angry about the increased taxes.*

- *She was angry with Mr. Khan for supporting her rivals*

- *He showed his dissatisfaction by becoming angry at his dog for barking.*

(x) *Liab*le and *apt* are sometimes used for *likely*.

Something is *apt* if it is “suited for, appropriate to” something else, or a person is *apt* if he has a tendency to do something or is ready to learn.

*Liab*le means “answerable for” and often suggests an undesirable possibility.

Likely means “*probably*”.

- *That was not an apt remark.*

- *He is liable to arrest.*

- *It will very likely rain tomorrow.*

(xi) Accept (a) to receive willingly

(b) to agree to

Except (a) to leave out

(b) but

- *All the workers except the part timers voted for a five day week.*

- *The management accepted the workers proposals.*

(xii) Advice: *suggestion(s)*

Advise: to give advice or suggestions to

- *Most astrologists' advice is worthless. They advise their clients in such a way that they become dependent upon them for guidance.*

-(xiii) Affect: as V, to influence
effect: (a) as V, to cause
(b) as N, result

- The heavy downpour last night did not affect the success of the trip. The rain had the effect of clearing the air of dust.

- His speech is sure to affect the voters.

- This film will have a great affect on the public.

- As Principal of the college he will effect certain changes in the curriculum.

(xiv) Desert: dry and sandy place (dez – ert)

Desert: to leave behind (de-zert)

Dessert: Final course of a meal

- *The boys were lost in the Thar desert.*

- *The soldier deserted the army*

- *The hostess offered rice pudding as dessert.*

(xv) Does: present tense of do

Dose: a measured amount of medicine.

- *Does a double dose of medicine cure an illness quicker?*

(xvi) Coarse: (a) rough

(b) not refined

Course: (a) a unit of instruction

(b) a part of a meal

(c) Use with *of* as in 'of course'

- *The secretaries are required to take a course in handling telephone calls so that do not treat even irritating customers in a coarse manner.*

- *Some of the boys on the computer course were very coarse in their manners.*

(xvii) Lead: (a) a metal

Led: (a) Influenced or persuaded

(b) guided

(c) past tense and past participle of the verb 'to lead'.

- The lead-based paint is dangerous for health.
- You must lead the child by the hand.
- I led the old woman by the hand last week.

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(xix) Quiet: Silent

Quite: very

Quit: (a) to give up

(b) stop doing something

- This is a quiet neighbourhood.
- 'This house is quite noisy', said the visitor.
- If you don't stop, quarrelling, I am going to quit being so patient', said the man to his wife.
- I have quite finished (adv – completely)
- His home is quite near to his office.

(xx) Wander: (a) to move with no definite or fixed course in mind

(b) to be unclear in speech

Wonder: (a) to be amazed;

(b) used to introduce polite requests, for inquiring

(c) to speculate or ask oneself

- I wandered lonely as a cloud
- I wonder if he is arriving
- I wonder at his innocence

Practice:

In the following sentences select the correct word from those given in brackets.

1. (You're, Your) the only person (who's, whose) never on time.
2. (Its, It's) different to (break, brake) the habit of taking drugs.
3. My neighbours discovered that (their, there) cat had eaten the mincemeat in the pan.
4. The (plane, plain) has (too, to, two) engines, and none was working.
5. The cheeky young man had (all ready, already) decided to (quit, quite, quiet) college, and he refused to (accept, except) his father's (advise, advice)
6. The rich (desert, dessert) had to (effect, affect) of giving guests a stomach ache. The host gave them each a double (dose, does) of sodamint tablets.
7. The ladies' complaints about the (coarse, course) language used in the waiting room (led, lead) the director to issue a warning letter to the male members.
8. The two brothers have not had any (peace, piece) ever since (their, there) father left them a (peace, piece) of land.
9. "Your overweight and you almost never exercise", the physician warned the man.
10. ('Whose, who's) application is this?' asked the office clerk. The young man raised his hand, (wandering, wondering) (weather, whether) the clerk thought his application was well written or not.